CUSTOMER GUIDE

# Moving & Packing Checklist

Your week-by-week guide to a calmer move, from eight weeks out to your first night in your new home.

wontstopmoving.com
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# Week-by-Week Checklist

## 6–8 Weeks Before Your Move

- [ ] Create a Moving Planner Folder to track every moving detail and keep receipts for moving-related expenses.
- [ ] Start using up things you can't move, such as frozen food and cleaning supplies.
- [ ] Research your new area: schools, hospitals, grocery stores and local services.
- [ ] If your employer is paying for the move, confirm your moving budget and what you're responsible for.
- [ ] Ask a tax professional whether any of your moving expenses are deductible.
- [ ] Make a list of items you're not taking, and decide whether to sell, donate or dispose of each.
- [ ] List everyone you need to notify: friends, professionals, creditors and subscriptions.
- [ ] Find your vehicle registration and licensing documents.
- [ ] Arrange storage for anything you need to keep off-site.
- [ ] Collect personal records: school, medical, legal and financial. Ask for referrals where useful.

## 5 Weeks Before Your Move

- [ ] Submit a change of address with your post office.
- [ ] Arrange transportation for pets and plants.
- [ ] Schedule utilities (gas, electric, water, internet, trash) to disconnect at your old home and connect at your new one. Keep the old home's utilities on through moving day.
- [ ] Set up insurance for your new home: auto, homeowner's or renter's, and health.
- [ ] Plan a garage sale, or arrange to donate items you no longer need.
- [ ] Make travel arrangements and reservations for your moving trip.

## 4 Weeks Before Your Move

- [ ] Sketch a floor plan of your new home and decide where furniture goes. File it in your Moving Planner Folder.
- [ ] If either building has elevators, contact building management to reserve elevator time and review their rules.

## 3 Weeks Before Your Move

- [ ] If you're packing yourself, get an assortment of boxes and packing supplies, and start packing things you won't need before the move.
- [ ] Have your car serviced if you'll be driving.
- [ ] Update your address with online stores, credit card companies and other accounts.

## 2 Weeks Before Your Move

- [ ] Confirm your booking details with your mover in your Wont Stop Moving dashboard.
- [ ] If you're doing your own packing, pack steadily now. Label every box clearly.
- [ ] Pack essentials together and mark those boxes "Open First / Load Last".
- [ ] Consider professional packing for fragile and valuable items.
- [ ] Close or move accounts at your local bank if you need to.
- [ ] Empty your safe deposit box, pick up dry cleaning, and return library books and rentals.
- [ ] Drain gas and oil from power equipment such as lawn mowers and snow blowers.

## 1 Week Before Your Move

- [ ] Review this whole checklist to make sure nothing was missed.
- [ ] Give your movers clear directions to your new home and a phone number where they can reach you.
- [ ] Disconnect major appliances and prepare them for transport.
- [ ] Pack a Trip Kit with what you'll need while your things are in transit. Keep it in your car so it isn't loaded on the truck.
- [ ] Call ahead to confirm utilities are connected at your new home.
- [ ] Confirm the crew's arrival time and share any last-minute details.

## Moving Day

- [ ] Have someone at home to meet the movers and answer questions.
- [ ] Keep your floor plan handy so you know where furniture and appliances go.
- [ ] Choose one person to direct where items are placed when the truck is unloaded.
- [ ] Unpack only what you need for the first day or two. Give yourself a couple of weeks to settle in.
- [ ] When the job is done to your satisfaction, give your mover your 6-digit release code. That's when they get paid.

# Labeling System

## Color code by room

| | |
|---|---|
| **Green** | Kitchen |
| **Blue** | Primary bedroom |
| **Red** | Living room |
| **Yellow** | Kids’ rooms |
| **Purple** | Bathroom |
| **Orange** | Garage / storage |
| **Pink** | Office |

## Label each box with

- Destination room, in large letters
- General contents
- Box number, for your inventory
- “FRAGILE” or “THIS SIDE UP” if needed

## Symbol system

| | |
|---|---|
| ★ | Unpack first (priority) |
| ○ | Not urgent |
| ! | Fragile: handle with care |
| ↑ ↑ | This side up |

**Pro tip:** Label the top and two sides of every box so you can read it when boxes are stacked.

# Packing Tips

- **Heavy items in small boxes**
  books, tools, canned goods
- **Light items in large boxes**
  linens, pillows, lampshades
- **Heavier items at the bottom**
  lighter items on top
- **Keep boxes under 50 lbs**
  if you can't lift it comfortably, it's too heavy
- **Fill empty space**
  so contents don't shift in transit
- **Photograph electronics**
  before you disconnect the cables
- **Pack plates on edge**
  like records, with padding between each
- **Use suitcases for heavy items**
  they're built to carry weight
- **Ask before leaving drawers full**
  light items can sometimes stay in place, secured with stretch wrap
- **Keep cleaning supplies separate**
  for the final clean of your old home

## Notes

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# Ready to move?

Get an instant quote and book vetted, independent movers online.
Your mover is paid only after you confirm the job is done.

**wontstopmoving.com/quote**

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